



FREE GUIDE · FOR OPTOMETRY

The Optometry Practice's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Low-waste, but not no-waste — expired drops
and the occasional sharp, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Low-waste, not no-waste.

Optometry is a low-waste setting — but not a no-waste one. Expired diagnostic and dilating drops, anesthetic drops, and the occasional injection or diagnostic sharp are still regulated and can't just go in the trash. This short guide covers exactly what you generate and the simplest compliant way to handle it.

The good news

A small practice doesn't need a hauler or a contract — prepaid mail-back kits, sized to your low volume, with a Certificate of Destruction.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired diagnostic, dilating, and anesthetic eye drops and medications.



GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired dilating & diagnostic drops
- Topical anesthetic drops
- Other expired non-controlled meds

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

Occasional injection and diagnostic sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Injection needles & syringes
- Diagnostic lancets
- Any single-use sharps

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 03

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Any blood-contaminated materials (uncommon in optometry).

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-contaminated gauze
- Contaminated PPE
- Procedure waste (if any)

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The optometry compliance checklist.

- ☐ Expired diagnostic and dilating drops destroyed as pharmaceutical waste, not flushed.
- ☐ Any injection or diagnostic sharps in an FDA-cleared container.
- ☐ Blood-contaminated materials (rare) red-bagged if they occur.
- ☐ Kits sized to a low-volume practice — no over-buying.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.
- ☐ No contract or minimums to maintain.

QUESTIONS OPTOMETRISTS ASK

Your optometry questions, answered.

Do we even need a disposal service for an optometry office?

For your low volume, a prepaid mail-back kit is usually all you need — no hauler, no contract. It covers expired drops and the occasional sharp.

How do we dispose of expired dilating or anesthetic drops?

As pharmaceutical waste — destroyed with documentation, not poured down the drain.

We rarely use needles — what do we do with the few we have?

Keep a small FDA-cleared sharps container and a sharps mail-back kit on hand; mail it when it's full.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back kits sized to a low-volume optometry practice — expired drops and the occasional sharp — destroyed at our DEA-registered facility with a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Expired drops / meds	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Injection / diagnostic sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Blood-contaminated waste (rare)	Biohazard mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Mail-back is almost always right for optometry. If you're a larger group, we can size a program — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY OPTOMETRY PRACTICES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order



Ready to simplify your optometry practice waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop